Lesson 7 — The Bench by the Stairs

Part 11 of 12: Answer key and teacher notes

Level: B1 (seventh step)

About 10 minutes · this part carries a sheet

Listening: L1 — under the stairs in the engineering building; two students, on Sunday, Tuesday and Thursday afternoons · L2 — learning what she must not touch · L3 — a capacitor inside can hold a charge for days after the plug is pulled · L4 — a fan packed with dust

Part A (MCQ): 1-B · 2-C · 3-D · 4-A · 5-B · 6-C · 7-C · 8-B · 9-B · 10-B

Why 7 is [C]: the sentence says that some of what the bench produces is not a repair, and only the paragraph after [C] is about the machines they turn away — the burnt board, the one under warranty, the card with the reason on it. The paragraph after [A] is Maysa's own history, after [B] the rules of care, after [D]** the log.

Why 8 is B**: the capacitor is given so that the rule stops being arbitrary. Every other rule on the list can be bent; that one cannot, and the capacitor is why. It is not there to show off her knowledge or to sell anything.

Why 9 is B**: the passage teaches no repair you could actually carry out, asks the college for nothing, and compares nothing. It describes how the bench is run, and most of its detail is about judgement — what to check first, what to refuse.

Why 10 is B, admiring: not sentimental, which is the trap. Sentimental writing would call her brave or the bench a lifeline. This writer gives her the last word, reports the rules without comment, and records that only half of the machines go away working. Admiration shown by accurate detail is still admiration, and TOEFL wants the stronger, narrower word.

Part B (True/False):

1. F — She studies information systems, and had to learn repair herself.
2. T
3. F — You do not have to be quick; you do have to be able to put it back together.
4. F — It cannot be mended there. A broken screen can be, if the part exists.
5. T
6. F — She says it must have better light before anything else.

Part C (Fill in the blanks): 1. capacitor · 2. static · 3. dust · 4. fault · 5. log · 6. warranty · 7. component (Extra words: diagnose, bench)

2.4 A (Opposites): 1. cool down · 2. keep · 3. dangerous · 4. unusual / interesting · 5. out of warranty

2.4 B (Odd one out): 1. warranty (the others are things on the bench) · 2. diagnose (the others are parts) · 3. log (the others are things that build up or come out of a machine)

Come back to (simple or continuous): 1. has been — be is a state verb · 2. have been keeping · 3. has known — know is a state verb · 4. has been cleaning

3.6 A (choose the modal): 1. must · 2. can · 3. should · 4. had to · 5. Could

3.6 B (must not or do not have to): 1. must not · 2. do not have to · 3. must not · 4. do not have to

3.6 C (past): 1. had to replace · 2. could repair · 3. should have checked

3.6 D (simple or continuous): 1. has been — state verb · 2. have been repairing · 3. has known — state verb · 4. has been cleaning

Mini-quiz: 1. should · 2. had to · 3. must not is forbidden; do not have to is simply not necessary · 4. hafta · 5. cool down · 6. diagnose · 7. log · 8. any two of: be, know, own, understand, believe, need, want, like, mean, belong, cost, seem · 9–12. teacher judgement

Teacher Notes

What changed from Lesson 6, and what deliberately did not. 510 words against Lesson 6's 504 — the plateau is holding, and it is meant to. The difficulty this week is in the grammar and in the vocabulary, which is the most technical the course has used: capacitor, static, component, diagnose, warranty. The question set is untouched for the second lesson running. By now she should not have to read the question labels at all.

The one real difficulty. Section 3.5, and nothing else comes close. must not and do not have to look like a negative pair and are not: one forbids, the other releases. Arabic marks these with different constructions, so the error is not a translation error — it is a false friend created by English's own symmetry. The passage was written so that both land within four lines of each other (you must not open a power supply / you do not have to be quick), which gives you a natural place to stop and ask her which is which. If only one thing survives this lesson, make it that.

The second difficulty, which is quieter. Must has no past. Students who have learned must well will write yesterday I must replace the fan for months. 3.6 C drills it; so does the speaking question about something she had to learn.

Why the pronunciation part is the one to protect. Can and can't are the only pair in English where mishearing one word reverses the whole sentence, and the difference is not the t — in connected speech the t usually disappears before a consonant. It is the vowel length and the stress: /k*ə*n/ unstressed against /k*aː*nt/ long and stressed. A student listening for the t will keep agreeing to things nobody offered. The hafta / hasta section is easier and pays off immediately in listening.

On the "Come back to" section. Lesson 5 taught the present perfect continuous and did not say that a whole family of verbs refuses it. I have been knowing him for a year is a very durable error. The list is short enough to learn outright, and the passage supplies two natural models in its first paragraph — it has been there for two years — which is a state verb in the simple, exactly where a student would want the continuous.

Why this story. Modals are the grammar of rules, permission and judgement, so the passage had to be somewhere with rules. A repair bench gives all five modals real work in one setting: what you can do, what you could do with more, what you should do, what you must do, what you must not do, and what

somebody had to learn. It is also the most technical passage so far, which is where the difficulty has moved now that the length has stopped moving.

Success criteria for Lesson 7. The student should be able to:

- answer L1–L4 correctly on the second hearing;
- hear we can't replace that and not write we can;
- choose between must not and do not have to and explain the difference;
- use had to for past necessity, never must;
- use should have + past participle for advice that was not taken;
- use a state verb in the present perfect simple without reaching for the continuous;
- use 10 of the 14 key words in her own sentence;
- write 14 sentences of instructions with fewer than 4 modal errors.

If it is too easy: add may, might and be able to to the family, and ask her to rewrite the bench's rules as polite requests for a customer-facing help desk. If it is too hard: teach must / must not / should only this week and leave have to for a second pass. Do not cut part 05, which is worth more than any of the written work here.

A note on spaced recall. `03-vocabulary.mp3` ends with five Lesson 5 words — battery, repair, install, program, delete. Lesson 6 recalled Lesson 4, so the two-lesson gap holds. Lesson 6's words are due back in Lesson 8.

A note on the games. Five again: crossword, word search, memory pairs, criss-cross and cryptogram, all built from this lesson's own vocabulary. The cryptogram is worth setting as the last one, a week after the lesson: the words are long and technical this time (capacitor, screwdriver, component), so the spelling drill is doing real work.